



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Namibia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that! It's great that you're thinking ahead about your future. Since you're 16 and just finished primary school in Denmark (which typically ends at 9th or 10th grade), your next step usually involves choosing a youth education program. Here's a breakdown of your main options in Denmark, depending on your interests, goals, and strengths:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These programs prepare you for university or other higher education. If you enjoy academic subjects and might want to go to university later, this is a strong choice.

Options include:

- **STX** (Studentereksamen): Broadest academic program with subjects like Danish, English, history, science, etc.
- **HHX** (Higher Commercial Examination): Focuses on business, economics, and languages.
- **HTX** (Higher Technical Examination): Focuses on technology, natural sciences, and innovation.
- **HF** (Higher Preparatory Examination): A 2-year program, often for slightly older students or those who prefer a shorter academic route.

🧠 *Best for:* Students interested in continuing to university or professional careers in fields like business, engineering, medicine, or social sciences.

🔧 2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training, EUD)

This is for you if you want to learn a trade or get a job more quickly. You split your time between school and internships.

Examples:

- Electrician
- Carpenter
- Hairdresser
- Healthcare assistant
- Mechanic
- IT-supporter

You can also choose **EUX**, which combines vocational training with academic subjects, so you can work *and* still have the option to go to university later.

 *Best for:* Students who like hands-on work and want a direct path to a job.

How to Choose?

Here are some guiding questions:

1. **Do you like school subjects and want to study more in depth?**
→ Go for **STX**, **HTX**, **HHX**, or **HF**.
 2. **Are you more practical and want to start working earlier?**
→ Choose **EUD** or **EUX**.
 3. **Not sure yet?**
→ Many people choose **STX** or **HF** to keep doors open. Or explore an **EUX**, which gives both options.
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Extra Considerations for You:

- Being bilingual (Danish and possibly a Namibian language or English) can be a great asset—especially in business, international studies, or social work.
 - Look into mentorship or support networks for young people with immigrant backgrounds—many programs in Denmark support diversity in education.
 - Don't be afraid to contact schools for open house events (åbent hus) to get a feel for what fits you.
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Next Steps:

1. **Talk to a student counselor (UU-vejleder)** – they'll help you understand your local options.
2. **Visit education fairs or open house events.**
3. **Apply through the optagelse.dk website** (usually deadlines are around March for the next school year, but check your local rules).

Would you like help thinking through which option might suit your interests or personality better? If you tell me what subjects or activities you enjoy, I can give a more tailored recommendation.